

FINDING A PLACE TO SERVE

Blue denotes power point slide

Brown denotes instructions to technician

TEXT: I Peter 4:10-12 (CEV) *“Each of you has been blessed with one of God's many wonderful gifts to be used in the service of others. So use your gift well. ¹¹If you have the gift of speaking, preach God's message. If you have the gift of helping others, do it with the strength that God supplies. Everything should be done in a way that will bring honor to God because of Jesus Christ, who is glorious and powerful forever. Amen.”*

Ecclesiastes 9:10 (NKJV) *“Whatever your hand finds to do, do it with your might; for there is no work or device or knowledge or wisdom in the grave where you are going.”*

INTRO: Today we are going to be talking about a commitment to serve. Many Christians only have a vague idea of what is involved in serving God. Someone said, *“It is true that most people would like to serve God, but only in an advisory capacity!”*

Do you know anyone like that? I am not

talking about anyone here today but I'm sure most of you know people who serve God and the church in an advisory capacity!
(Anonymous letter)

There are two non-negotiable elements to serving: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Serving requires hands-on activity...
- Serving requires commitment...

God and this church already have enough advisors; the only openings that still remain are hands-on responsibilities that require a commitment in the good times and the difficult times.

When making a commitment to serve some people want to know what the minimum requirement will be.

At times, many of us attempt to avoid a Commitment to serve the Lord, especially:

- If it is not easy for us to do...
- If we feel inadequate for the task...
- If we are afraid of success or failure...

There are at least three things that go into finding our place to serve Lord and others:

(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Gift Giving...
- Gift Discovery...
- Gift Deployment...

I. GIFT GIVING...

1 Peter 4:10 (CEV) ***“Each of you has been blessed with one of God’s many wonderful gifts to be used in the service of others. So use your gift well.”*** Every human being has been given at least one gift by God to use in His service. Many people say, *“I don’t have any gifts or talents.”* This is not a scriptural point of view. Many times Scripture references the fact that each individual has been given one or more gifts that are to be used in serving God and others.

The reason some people do not recognize there God given gifts is because they have never been developed. At other times, **gifts are overlooked** because they do not seem very spiritual. For example: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- A person who is gifted to work with their hands...
- A person who is gifted with administration...

- A person who is gifted in the area of helping...
- A person who is gifted with compassion...

The aforementioned gifts are often overlooked because we do not see them in a spiritual sense.

Romans 12:6-8 (NKJV) ***“Having then gifts differing according to the grace that is given to us, let us use them: if prophecy, let us prophesy in proportion to our faith; ⁷ or ministry, let us use it in our ministering; he who teaches, in teaching; ⁸ he who exhorts, in exhortation; he who gives, with liberality; he who leads, with diligence; he who shows mercy, with cheerfulness.”*** 1 Corinthians 12:4-7 (NKJV) ***“There are diversities of gifts, but the same Spirit. ⁵ There are differences of ministries, but the same Lord. ⁶ And there are diversities of activities, but it is the same God who works all in all. ⁷ But the manifestation of the Spirit is given to each one for the profit of all.”*** (For years I excused poor administration on being a preacher, not an administrator)

II. GIFT DISCOVERY...

In our Commitment to serve, we must be constantly on the lookout for ways that God has gifted us. When it comes to gifts, it is the

responsibility of the believer to: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Discover the gift...
- Develop the gift...
- Properly use the gift...

How can we know what abilities we have individually been given? **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Pray to discover the gifts...
- Find out what your passions are...
- Look into what you are naturally good at...

This next truth is going to set some of you free today; don't be afraid to try out some ways of serving God by volunteering for short term assignments. If you volunteer for something and discover you are not good at it or passionate about it, give proper notice and move on to something else, but don't quit and sit idly by doing nothing!

III. GIFT DEPLOYMENT...

I Peter 4:10 (CEV) ***"Each of you has been blessed with one of God's many wonderful gifts to be used in the service of others. So use your gift well."***

Charles Kingsley said, *“Have your tools ready and God will find you some work.”* The Lord told J. Hudson Taylor, *“I am going to evangelize China, and if you will walk with me, I will do it through you.”*

Ecclesiastes 9:10 (NKJV) *“Whatever your hand finds to do, do it with your might; for there is no work or device or knowledge or wisdom in the grave where you are going.”*

In these last day's it is urgent for all believers to deploy their gifts! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE ED OF THE SERVICE)** They need to be deployed now!

Wilbert Welch chancellor of Grand Rapids Baptist College said, *“It's time we stopped staring up the steps and started steadily stepping up the stairs!”*

We have already been commissioned, Jesus said, *“Go and make disciples of all nations...”*

The want ads in the modern day church look like this:

- For Sale – One cross, almost new, top heavy, cramps my style as I am trying to keep up with the world...

- For Sale - One talent, slightly shelf-worn unused for several years, may need a little updating...
- For Sale - One bundle of seldom used opportunities, among these; church attendance; personal witnessing; tithing; and serving...
- For Sale - Badly used influence, buyer will need to make repairs and use it more carefully...

These items may be seen anytime in the basement of my home at the corner of Careless Avenue and Neglect Street.

Careless Christian

You don't have to wait until you can serve perfectly, just make a commitment to start serving! Start where you are, and start serving now!

You are released for ministry! Every one of you, I am releasing you, this church is releasing you, deploy now!

Ecclesiastes 9:10 (NKJV) **“Whatever your hand finds to do, do it with your might; for there is no work or device or knowledge or**

wisdom in the grave where you are going.”